



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Professional Development

ACCOUNTING APPLICATIONS SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
2. Describe techniques for obtaining work experience.
3. Explain possible advancement patterns for jobs.
4. Identify sources of career information.
5. Analyze employer expectations in the business environment.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a staff accountant at MIDTOWN FINANCIAL SERVICES, a medium-sized accounting firm. The Human Resources Director (judge) has asked you to prepare for an internal presentation on career development for new hires at the firm.

The Human Resources Director (judge) wants you to focus on how junior accountants can take ownership of their career paths and the types of professional development that can lead to growth within the company. They have asked you to address the following topics:

- Steps to obtain relevant certifications, such as CPA, CFA (Chartered Financial Analyst), and their relevance to the firm
- How attending accounting conferences and networking events can lead to career opportunities
- The role of mentorship within the firm and how building relationships with senior colleagues can enhance career development
- Key accounting technologies and software (e.g., QuickBooks, SAP) that employees should master to stay competitive in the industry

You will present this information to the Human Resources Director (judge) in a role-play that takes place in their office. The director (judge) will begin the role-play by asking you to outline the professional development strategies you recommend for the new hires. After you have presented your ideas and answered any questions, the director (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your suggestions.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Can you explain the specific benefits of obtaining both the CPA and CFA certifications, and how they differ in relevance to career growth at Midtown Financial Services?
2. What strategies would you suggest to ensure that junior accountants build strong mentorship relationships with senior colleagues?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Describe techniques for obtaining work experience?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain possible advancement patterns for jobs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Identify sources of career information?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Analyze employer expectations in the business environment?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						